

veining near the bases and are touched yellow around the throats. Z3-8

I. tuberosa, syn. *Hermodactylus tuberosus* (Widow iris), illus. p.406.

I. unguicularis, syn. *I. stylosa* (Algerian iris, Algerian winter iris, Winter iris). Evergreen, rhizomatous, beardless iris. H to 8in (20cm). Has narrow, tough leaves. Almost stemless, primrose-scented, lilac flowers, 2-3in (5-8cm) across with yellow centers to the falls and with very long tubes, are produced from late fall to early spring. Buds are prone to slug attack. Excellent for cutting. Prefers a sheltered site against a south- or west-facing wall. Z7-9. **‘Mary Barnard’** has deep violet-blue flowers. **subsp. cretensis** (syn. *I. cretensis*; illus. p.224), H 4in (10cm), has violet or lavender-blue standards and white or yellow falls with violet veining at the bases and clear violet tips. Flowers of **‘Walter Butt’** are pale silvery-lavender.

I. variegata (Variegated iris; illus. p.225). Rhizomatous, bearded iris. H 12-20in (30-50cm). In early summer, branched stem produces 3-6 flowers, 2-3in (5-8cm) across, with bright yellow standards and white or pale yellow falls, heavily veined red-brown and appearing striped. Z5-9

I. verna. Rhizomatous, beardless iris. H 2in (5cm). In midspring, produces 1, occasionally 2, lilac-blue flowers, 1-2in (2.5-5cm) across, with a narrow, orange stripe in the center of each fall. Prefers semishade and moist but well-drained soil. Z5-9

I. versicolor (Blue flag, Wild iris) illus. p.442. Prefers partial shade and thrives in moist soil or in shallow water. Z5-9.

‘Kermesina’ bears red-purple flowers.

I. ‘Violet Beauty’, syn. *I. reticulata* ‘Violet Beauty’. Bulbous Reticulata iris. H 4-6in (10-15cm), S 1½-2½in (4-6cm). In early spring, bears a solitary, fragrant, long-tubed, deep violet-purple flower, 1½-2½in (4-6cm) across, with an orange ridge down the center of each fall. Narrow, squared leaves elongate after flowering time. Z5-9

I. warleyensis. Bulbous Juno iris. H 8-18in (20-45cm), S 7-3in (8cm). In spring, produces up to 5 pale lilac or violet-blue flowers, 2-3in (5-7cm) across, in leaf axils. Each fall has a darker blue apex and a yellow stain in the center. Has scattered, lance-shaped, channeled, mid-green leaves. Best in an unheated greenhouse. Z6-8

I. ‘White City’. Vigorous Rhizomatous, bearded iris (Tall). H 3ft (90cm). Bears very pale blue, fragrant flowers, fading to white, in early summer. The falls have a yellow beard. Z3-9

I. ‘White Swirl’. Rhizomatous, beardless Siberian iris. H 3ft (1m). In early summer, produces pure white flowers, flushed golden yellow at the bases, with rounded, flaring petals. Z3-9

I. winogradowii (illus. p.225). Bulbous Reticulata iris. H 2½-4in (6-10cm), S 2½-3in (6-7cm). Solitary pale primrose-yellow flower, 2½-3in (6-7cm) across, spotted green on falls, is produced in early spring. Narrow, squared leaves are short at flowering time but elongate later. Z6-8

I. ‘Winter Olympics’. Rhizomatous, bearded iris (Tall). H 3ft (90cm). In early summer, produces striking, pure white

flowers, with slightly ruffled edges to standards and a white beard. Z3-9

I. xiphioides. See *I. latifolia*.

I. xiphium. Bulbous Xiphium iris (Spanish). H to 32in (80cm), S 6in (15cm). Bears 1 or 2 blue or violet, occasionally yellow or white, flowers, 2½-3in (6-8cm) across, with central orange or yellow marks on the falls, in spring and early summer. Narrowly lance-shaped, channeled, mid-green leaves are scattered on flower stem. Z5-9. Flowers of **‘Lusitanica’** are pure yellow.

ISATIS

BRASSICACEAE/CRUCIFERAE

Genus of summer-flowering annuals, biennials and perennials. Needs sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Ideal for a wild garden; *I. tinctoria* is suitable for a herb garden. Propagate by seed in fall or spring.

I. tinctoria (Woad). Vigorous, upright biennial. H to 4ft (1.2m), S 1½ft (45cm). Has oblong to lance-shaped, glaucous leaves and, in summer, large, terminal panicles of 4-petaled, yellow flowers. Z4-8

ISMELIA

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of one species of annuals, grown for its attractive, daisylike flower heads. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. Suitable for a border or wild flower meadow. Propagate by seed in spring.

I. carinata, syn. *Chrysanthemum carinatum*, *C. tricolor*. **‘Monarch Court Jesters’** is a fast-growing, erect, branching annual. H 2ft (60cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has feathery, gray-green leaves and, in summer, daisylike, zoned flower heads, to 3in (8cm) across, in various color combinations. **Tricolor Series** is a group of fast-growing, upright, branching annuals. H 1-2ft (30-60cm), S 1ft (30cm). Have feathery, light green leaves and, in summer, daisylike, single or double flower heads, to 3in (8cm) across, in many color combinations. Tall cultivars, H 2ft (60cm), S 1ft (30cm), and dwarf, H and S 1ft (30cm), are available. Z5-9

ISMENE

AMARYLLIDACEAE

Genus of bulbs grown for their large, white, scented flowers. Similar to *Hymenocallis* and *Pancratium*. Requires a sheltered position in sun or partial shade, in rich, well drained soil. Plant out in early summer, lifting before the first frosts in cold areas, or grow under glass with a winter min. 50-60°F (10-15°C), reduce watering in winter, repot in spring. Propagate by offsets when repotting or by seed sown when ripe.

I. calathina. See *I. narcissiflora*.

I. x deflexa, syn. *Hymenocallis festalis*. Spring- or summer-flowering bulb. H to 32in (80cm), S 12-18in (30-45cm). Produces a basal cluster of strap-shaped, semierect leaves. Bears a head of 2-5 scented, white flowers, each 8in (20cm) across with a deep, central cup and 6 narrow, reflexed petals. Z8-10 (min. 50°F/10°C)

I. x macrostephana. See *Hymenocallis x macrostephana*.

I. narcissiflora, syn. *Hymenocallis calathina*, *H. narcissiflora*, *I. calanthina* (Peruvian daffodil), illus. p.408.

I. x spofforthiae ‘Sulphur Queen’, syn. *Hymenocallis x spofforthiae ‘Sulphur Queen’*, illus p.412.

ISOLEPIS

CYPERACEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.

I. setacea, syn. *Scirpus setaceus* (Bristle club-rush). Tuft-forming, annual or short-lived, perennial rush. H 4-6in (10-15cm), S 3in (8cm). Has very slender, lax, basal leaves. Very slender, unbranched stems each bear 1-3 minute, egg-shaped, green spikelets in summer. Z12-15

Isoplexis canariensis. See *Digitalis canariensis*.

ISOPYRUM

RANUNCULACEAE

Genus of spring-flowering perennials, grown for their small, anenome-like, usually white, flowers and delicate foliage. Suitable for peat beds, woodland gardens and rock gardens. Requires shade and humus-rich, moist soil. Propagate by seed when fresh or by division in fall. Self-seeds readily.

I. thalictroides. Dainty, clump-forming perennial. H and S 10in (25cm). Central stalk bears fernlike, deeply divided, 3-parted leaves, each leaflet being cut into 3. Produces small, nodding, cup-shaped, white flowers in spring. Z5-8

ISOTOMA

CAMPANULACEAE

Genus of perennials, often grown as annuals, for their freely borne, star-shaped, long-tubed flowers. Frequently used in containers and as summer bedding. Propagate by seed, sown at 61-64°F (16-18°C) in spring, or by softwood cuttings or division in summer. ☉Contact with the sap may irritate skin.

I. Avant-Garde Series illus. p.313

I. ‘Gemini’. Vigorous, mound-forming perennial, grown as an annual. H and S 1ft (30cm). Has finely divided, light green leaves. Produces abundant, slightly scented, star-shaped, pink or blue flowers throughout summer. Z9-11

Isotrema griffithii. See *Aristolochia griffithii*.

ITEA

ITEACEAE

Genus of deciduous or evergreen trees and shrubs, grown for their hollylike, foliage, their attractive fall color and their small, white, cream or green-white flowers. Where marginally hardy, protect by growing against a south- or west-facing wall. Needs sun or semishade and fertile, well-drained but not too dry soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer.

I. ilicifolia illus. p.211.

IXIA

IRIDACEAE

Genus of spring- and summer-flowering corms with wiry stems and spikes of flattish flowers. Grow in an open, sunny situation and in well-drained soil. Plant in fall for spring and early summer flowers; plant in spring for later summer display. Dry off after flowering. Propagate in fall by seed or by offsets at replanting time.

I. ‘Mabel’. Spring- to early summer-flowering corm. H 16in (40cm), S 1-2in (2.5-5cm). Has linear, basal, mid-green leaves and spikes of deep pink flowers. Z10-11

I. maculata. Spring- to early summer-flowering corm. H 16in (40cm), S 1-2in (2.5-5cm). Leaves are linear, erect and mostly basal. Wiry stem bears a spike of flattish, orange or yellow flowers, 1-2in (2.5-5cm) across, with brown or black centers. Z10-11

I. monadelpha. Spring- to early summer-flowering corm. H 1ft (30cm), S 1-2in (2.5-5cm). Linear, erect leaves are mostly basal. Stem produces a dense spike of 5-10 flattish, white, pink, purple or blue flowers, 1¼-1½in (3-4cm) across, often with differently colored eyes. Z10-11

I. viridiflora illus. p.406.

IXIOLIRION

IXIOLIRIACEAE

Genus of bulbs, grown for their funnel-shaped flowers mainly in spring. Needs a sheltered, sunny site and well-drained soil that becomes hot and dry in summer to ripen the bulb. Propagate, by seed or offsets, in fall.

I. montanum. See *I. tataricum*.

I. tataricum, syn. *I. montanum*, illus. p.403.

IXORA

RUBIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, summer-flowering shrubs and trees, grown primarily for their flowers, some also for their foliage. Prefers full sun and humus-rich, well-drained soil. Water containerized specimens freely when in full growth, moderately at other times. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer.

I. coccinea illus. p.456.